LATOYA THABILE MATAI

Junior Software Developer | Software Engineering Trainee
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SUMMARY

Software engineering trainee at WeThinkCode_ and Data Science student at IU International University of Applied Sciences. I build practical, user-centric apps in Python, Java, JavaScript, TypeScript and React, with hands-on experience in testing, debugging and database management. 4x Hackathon Top-3 Finisher, currently completing AWS re/Start training through Praesignis.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Programming:** Python, Java, JavaScript, TypeScript, C#/.NET
- **Frontend:** React, HTML, CSS, Tailwind CSS, responsive web development
- **Backend and Databases:** Java Spring Boot, SQL, PostgreSQL, SQLite
- **Cloud and Tools:** AWS, Microsoft Azure, Git, GitHub, Vercel, Docker
- **Practices:** Software testing, debugging, object-oriented programming, API integration, version control, documentation, data quality checks, teamwork and collaboration

PROJECTS

Nurse in Your Pocket

Solo project

- Built an AI health assistant so people can ask simple health questions without waiting in long clinic queues.
- Gives general guidance without acting as a doctor, and tells users to see a doctor when symptoms look serious.
- Stores clinic appointments with reminders of where to go and what to pack.
- Turns logged symptoms into a report for the clinic that can be saved to WhatsApp and shared with a doctor or family member.

Yazi Dev

Solo project

- Built an AI developer assistant that helps developers understand unfamiliar GitHub codebases.
- Connects to a repository and analyses its structure, technologies and dependencies, helps investigate bugs, and finds testing gaps.
- Integrates a large language model API as the AI layer, built around a real developer workflow rather than a generic chatbot.

Dainty Beauty

Solo project

- Designed and built a website for a facial treatment business showing its services, the areas it works in and how to find it.
- Added a link that sends customers straight to the business's WhatsApp to book.

ThusoAI

3rd Place, Cisco SheBuilds Hackathon | Team project

- Helps job seekers check whether a job link or interview invite is real, and gives them company contact details to verify anything suspicious.
- Tracks the interview journey with check-ins and notifications, and alerts an emergency contact if the phone switches off unexpectedly.

Echoes and Reflections

1st Place, Community Favourite, Campus Game Jam | Solo project

- Designed and built a memory puzzle game solo within the jam deadline after the original team was unavailable.
- Players memorise an arrow pattern, then re-enter it with the directions flipped. The pattern gets faster as it grows longer.

EXPERIENCE

Software Engineer in Training

WeThinkCode_, Parkwood, Johannesburg | Sept 2025 - Present (completing Dec 2026)

- Work in a project-based, work-simulated software engineering programme.
- Apply programming fundamentals and object-oriented programming to structured projects.
- Collaborate on software delivery and build knowledge through practical work and independent study.

Event Coordinator and Graphic Designer

WeThinkCode_, Parkwood, Johannesburg | Sept 2025 - Oct 2026

- Designed event graphics and coordinated logistics for campus events.
- Worked with students and staff to keep events organised and on schedule.

Social Media and Online Orders Specialist

The Bakers Warehouse, Bryanston, Johannesburg | July 2024 - Aug 2025

- Managed daily social media and WhatsApp posting to promote baked products and drive sales.
- Promoted baking classes and found customers to fill them.
- Processed online orders and shipped them to the correct addresses.
- Checked the website regularly to make sure ordering ran smoothly.
- Worked the till and handled cash, card and electronic payments, including on public holidays.
- Covered colleagues' roles, including the manager's, during absences and leave.

Earlier Roles

- Lead Generator, Nova Connect, Randburg | June 2023 - Sept 2023
- Sales Consultant, Lawson Direct Channel, Randburg | Feb 2023 - June 2023
- Spa Receptionist, The Houghton Hotel, Houghton Estate | Sept 2022 - Feb 2023

EDUCATION

- **IU International University of Applied Sciences** - Bachelor's Degree in Data Science, Remote, In Progress
- **WeThinkCode_** - Computer Software Engineering Programme, Johannesburg, Sept 2025 - Dec 2026
- **Afrika Tikkun** - Digital Marketing and SEO, Randburg, 2022 - 2023
- **Lavela Secondary School** - National Senior Certificate (Matric), Physical Sciences, Soweto, 2021

CERTIFICATIONS

- AWS re/Start, Praesignis (in progress)

AWARDS

- 4x Hackathon Top-3 Finisher
- 2nd Place, AfriHack Hackathon
- 3rd Place, Cisco SheBuilds Hackathon
- 3rd Place, Mukuru x WeThinkCode_ SheCodes Hackathon
- 1st Place, Community Favourite, Campus Game Jam

REFEREES

Available on request